DIGITAL LITERACY Project

Prepared by :

Mayank Sharma
[25BCE10272]

INTRODUCTION

- In today's digital world, digital literacy skills are required to effectively use online tools, communicate professionally, and to stay safe on the internet. In this project, I took on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, responsible for helping peers navigate the digital world and build responsible digital habits. The goal of this project was to create a Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates practical digital skills and awareness.
- To complete this project, I worked on five tasks covering different aspects of digital literacy. These included creating a digital literacy infographic, building professional online profiles, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, drafting professional emails, and researching cybercrime awareness. Each task helped me understand the importance of professional online presence, safe internet practices, and effective digital communication.

Task 1

- For Task 1, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness infographic using Canva. The infographic was designed to help students understand the importance of digital literacy and responsible online behaviour. It included sections such as what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online behaviour, and email etiquette. I structured the infographic in a clear and visually appealing layout so that students can quickly understand the information.
- While creating the infographic, I explored different templates, fonts, and design elements available in Canva. In the infographic, I mentioned tools such as GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Drive, and HackerRank, which are useful for students in their academic and professional journey. This task helped me understand how visual communication can make information easier to understand and more engaging. However, this task improved my creativity and helped me learn how to present information effectively using digital tools.

Task 2

- For Task 2, I created and updated my professional profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms are widely used by students, and professionals to showcase and develop skills, as well as to connect with others. On GitHub, I created a profile README that includes my name, branch, year, and my learning goalsI updated my education details, including my degree, university, and expected graduation year. This helps me build a professional network and connect with industry professionals. I also created a Kaggle profile to explore data science and machine learning concepts.
- Over the next four years, I plan to regularly upload projects on GitHub, connect with professionals and participate in discussions on LinkedIn, and explore datasets and competitions on Kaggle. These platforms will help me build a strong professional portfolio, improve my skills, and prepare for internships and placement opportunities. This task helped me understand the importance of maintaining a professional online presence.

Task 3

- For Task 3, I explored coding practice and collaboration platforms to improve my technical and digital skills. I created an account on HackerRank and completed some Python coding challenge and even received a badge. This helped me understand how coding platforms work and allowed me to practice problem-solving skills. Completing the challenge also gave me confidence in using programming concepts and improved my logical thinking abilities. In addition to coding practice, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms.
- The form included five questions related to digital literacy, safe internet practices, and digital tools. I also linked the responses to Google Sheets, which helped organize and analyse responses efficiently. I also made one of my friends complete the quiz and submit. This demonstrated how collaboration tools can be used for collecting data and sharing information. These platforms will help me academically by improving my coding skills and enabling collaboration with classmates.
- HackerRank will help me practice programming regularly, while Google Forms can be used for quizzes, surveys, and feedback collection. This task helped me understand the importance of coding practice and digital collaboration tools in academic and professional environments.

Task 4

- For Task 4, I created two professional emails and a social media do's and don'ts checklist. The first email was written to a professor requesting an extension for an assignment submission, and the second email was written to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity.
- While drafting these emails, I ensured that they included a clear subject line, greeting, concise body, and proper sign-off, making it look professional. A situation where poor digital communication can cause problems is when a student sends an informal email to a professor without a subject line or proper greeting. For example, sending a message like “Send notes fast” without context can appear rude and unclear. This may lead to misunderstandings or delay in response. In such cases, the student should write a proper email with a subject line, polite greeting, clear request, and respectful tone.
- This task helped me understand the importance of professional communication in academic and professional environments. Learning proper email etiquette and responsible social media behaviour will help me communicate effectively and maintain a professional online presence.

Task 5

- For Task 5, I researched cybercrime with a focus on UPI and online payment fraud. While researching, I learned how attackers trick users into sharing sensitive information through fake messages, payment requests, and phishing links. Students and young users are often targeted because they frequently use digital payment applications and may not verify requests carefully.
- I was surprised to learn how easily cybercriminals can create realistic messages that appear genuine. Many users unknowingly approve payment requests, thinking they are receiving money, which leads to financial loss. I also learned that quick reporting can increase the chances of recovering lost money.
- One habit I will personally change is verifying payment requests before approving them. I will also avoid clicking suspicious links and sharing personal information online. This task helped me understand the importance of cyber awareness and responsible digital behaviour, especially when using online payment platforms and digital services.

CONCLUSION

- This project helped me develop essential digital literacy skills such as creating a professional online presence, practicing safe internet usage, and communicating effectively through digital platforms. By completing the five tasks, I learned how to use tools like GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, HackerRank, and Google Forms for academic and professional growth. I also gained awareness about cybercrime and the importance of responsible digital behaviour.
- Overall, this project improved my understanding of digital tools, collaboration platforms, and professional communication. These skills will help me throughout my academic journey and future career. I will continue to improve my digital skills and maintain a professional and safe online presence.

REFERENCES

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